Rima Alshoufi

CREATIVE DIRECTOR & INTERIOR ARCHITECT

12+ years designing the sensory, emotional, and behavioral layer of physical space — translating brand identity into spatial narratives that shape movement, feeling, and memory across luxury retail, hospitality, and cultural environments in the GCC and Europe.

CONTACT

Dubai, UAE · GCC & Europe

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Portfolio

SECTORS

Luxury Retail · Hospitality · F&B · Cultural · Commercial · Residential

SKILLS & TOOLS

AI & Emerging Tools

Midjourney · DALL·E · Runway · ChatGPT · Notion AI · Adobe Firefly · AI Concept Viz · Prompt Design

Design & Technical

AutoCAD · 3Ds Max · SketchUp · Photoshop · Illustrator · InDesign · Canva · Figma · Notion

Professional

Strategic Planning · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Campaign Storytelling · Visual Merchandising · Workflow Optimization · Brand Guidelines

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Professional
French	Basic

CREDENTIALS

UAE Golden Visa
Creative Category

Inside LVMH Certificate
Brand Experience & Innovation

Design Jury Member
Sup de Luxe, Paris · 2025

48H de la Créativité
Winner · Franco-Syrian · 2010

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Concept Director | Spatial Experience Practice
Nov 2024 — Present

Self-Employed · Dubai, UAE & Lausanne, Switzerland

- Lead concept direction and spatial strategy for luxury retail, hospitality, and cultural environments — translating brand identity into journey, sequence, and atmosphere.
- Direct narrative-led design development from brief to built intent; align stakeholders, consultants, and contractors on quality, feasibility, and execution realism.
- Deploy AI-driven visualization and rapid concept iteration to accelerate client decision-making and protect design intent through delivery.

Creative Director
Oct 2022 — Nov 2024

Mohamed Hilal Group (MHG) · Dubai, UAE

Led creative strategy, spatial identity, and 360° campaign direction for a group of luxury retail, fragrance, and F&B brands — aligning physical, digital, and content touchpoints into one cohesive brand narrative.

- Designed and rolled out flagship retail concepts and scalable multi-site formats across the GCC and selected global markets.
- Directed 360° collection launches integrating spatial design, product storytelling, and digital content — extended launch narratives into luxury immersive events and activations.
- Conceived and delivered the Emovation Lab — a permanent sensory innovation platform for fragrance, emotion, and brand engagement.
- Led immersive brand activations at Dubai Design Week and Abu Dhabi Art Week, translating brand worlds into live spatial experiences.
- Directed prestige creative collaborations with heritage houses (Christofle, Moser), embedding international luxury codes into locally resonant brand storytelling.
- Pioneered AI-enhanced visualization and generative design workflows across the creative team.
- Built and led a multi-disciplinary team across interior design, visual merchandising, content, and production.
- Directed launch of MHG mobile app and loyalty program — aligning UX, digital storytelling, and retention mechanics with the end-to-end brand experience.

Design Manager | Head of Interior Architecture & Design
Oct 2018 — Oct 2022

Mohamed Hilal Group (MHG) · Dubai, UAE

Headed the Interior Architecture & Design department, delivering flagship environments end-to-end (concept to site) and elevating luxury standards across retail, hospitality, commercial, and residential. Reported directly to the CEO.

- Led flagship concepts and multi-site rollouts for Hind Al Oud, Khaltat, Anfasic Dukhoon, HOB, Michael Cromer, Hilal, and Khales across GCC and international locations.
- Designed and delivered HOB (Yas Mall) — the group's premier luxury department store — managing the full design sequence from brand identity translation to handover and UAE-wide rollout.
- Designed MHG Headquarters (2,600 sqm) — focused on employee well-being through spatial choreography and experience-driven workplace design.
- Created the Emovation Lab — the first sensory innovation space at Sharjah Research Technology & Innovation Park (SRTIP).
- Led concept design for boutique hotels and high-end residential projects, maintaining architectural rigor across typologies and scale.
- Translated international luxury watch, jewelry, and eyewear brand concepts into in-store concession execution — ensuring compliance with global brand guidelines and adapting specs to regional build conditions.
- Managed full project lifecycle: concept development, space planning, FF&E, technical drawings, tendering, contractor management, and site supervision — ensuring the built outcome matched the atmospheric intent.

Design Manager
Apr 2014 — Jun 2018

Catalina Design Group · Dubai, UAE

Led the design department across 50+ commercial, residential, hospitality, and F&B projects in the UAE. Managed end-to-end delivery from concept through on-site handover.

- Directed full project lifecycle: concept, space planning, FF&E, client presentations, technical drawings, tendering, contractor coordination, and site supervision.
- Led and mentored a team of designers — ensuring design quality, delivery discipline, and operational efficiency across multiple parallel projects.
- Managed BOQs, contracts, and authority approvals (Dubai Municipality, Civil Defense), maintaining budget control and regulatory compliance.
- Delivered luxury styling outcomes — including FF&E specification, accessories, color schemes, and material finishing across residential and hospitality typologies.

Event Designer
Aug 2013 — Mar 2014

Meraas Holding (Duvent) · Dubai, UAE

- Conceptualized and supported delivery of large-scale corporate activations and high-profile entertainment productions for one of Dubai's leading development groups.
- Produced event design concepts, spatial layouts, and documentation to support execution teams across multi-venue, multi-stakeholder events.
- Coordinated with production, logistics, and venue teams to ensure design intent was maintained through build and show-day execution.

Events: Cirque du Soleil — Michael Jackson Immortal Tour (Dubai WTC) · Sofitel The Palm Grand Opening · Shah Rukh Khan Concert · JBR Beach & Pool Courts Grand Opening · Cityscape Exhibition

EDUCATION

MBA — Luxury Management
Sup de Luxe (Founded by Cartier) · Paris, France
2023 — 2024

BA — Interior Architecture
Damascus University
2009 — 2013

SELECTED BRAND & ENVIRONMENT EXPERIENCE

Waldorf Astoria · Sofitel · JW Marriott · Galeries Lafayette · Printemps · Harvey Nichols · Bloomingdale's · Sephora · Tryano · Christofle · Moser

Atmosphere is a strategy, not a side effect.